

Free Scene "Monica and Anne" by Jonathan Dorf

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Monica and Anne

From [4 A.M.](#)

Anne and Monica, her guest, both mid-teens, lie in a dark bedroom. Anne is awake, but Monica sleeps. Anne stands over her, trying to decide if she's awake. **4 A.M.** is published by Playscripts. [Click here to order a copy.](#)

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ANNE

Monica, are you awake?

(Beat.)

Monica?

(Beat.)

Monica!

MONICA

What?

ANNE

Are you awake?

(Monica groans.)

MONICA

What are you doing?

ANNE

What are you doing?

MONICA

Sleeping.

ANNE

You can't.

(Monica turns over and tries to ignore her. Beat. Anne turns on the lights. Monica groans.)

This isn't working for me.

MONICA

What? Turn off the lights.

ANNE

This is supposed to be a sleepover, but you're just...sleeping.

MONICA

It's...what time is it?

ANNE

Four. And we should be up, talking about guys and dyeing each other's hair purple, text messaging our friends to tell them what an amazing time we're having—

MONICA

Sleepover. Sleep.

(Monica tries to cover her head with a pillow, but Anne pulls it off.)

ANNE

It has nothing to do with sleep. If you wanted to sleep, you should have stayed home.

MONICA

What's wrong with you?

ANNE

Me?! Did we cross into an alternate universe where up is down?

MONICA

What time did you say it was?

ANNE

Four.

MONICA

Everybody's asleep at four.

ANNE

Not at a sleepover. By four we should be confiding our deepest, darkest secrets, secrets so secret that we have to swear on the grave of an A-list celebrity never to tell.

(Monica tries to hide under the covers, but Anne starts to pull them off.)

MONICA

Hey!

ANNE

(As they struggle:)

What if people found out that we...slept?!

(Monica, with a forceful pull, comes up with the blanket.)

MONICA

(Beat.)

I won't tell anyone.

ANNE

Once you're on the list, do you know how hard it is to get off?

MONICA

I promise.

ANNE

It's like a big black lipstick smudge of Cain on your forehead. No one's gotten it off in the history of

(Anne should say the name of her school:)

MONICA

I promise I won't tell. What if I got up extra early—

ANNE

It is extra early.

(Beat—starting to pack Monica's things:)

I never would've invited you if I'd known you'd be like this.

MONICA

Wait—

(Beat.)

I want to swap secrets and talk about guys...

ANNE

(Stops packing:)

Yeah...? I'm listening.

MONICA

We could set a time—eight. Nobody's gonna' be up at eight on a Saturday. We could do all that, and they'd never know.

ANNE

I'd know, and what if it just slips out? I see how you look at Ryan. Your mouth opens—you look like a whale from science class feeding on plankton.

Yeah—you get all whale mouthy, and something might just slip out.

MONICA

Four hours. That's all I ask.

ANNE

You ask too much.

(Beat.)

I could maybe do it, if I had some kind of proof that you won't say anything.

MONICA

Proof?

ANNE

Like a hostage.

(Beat.)

Yeah. If I had a hostage, maybe we could make this work.

MONICA

But I promised—

ANNE

Just cause you're on honor roll doesn't mean you don't lie. I mean, it's not like I know you.

MONICA

We've been best friends since kindergarten.

ANNE

I thought I did, but then this, and now you're like some stranger from off the street. Speaking Russian.

MONICA

Come on—we were green tea goddesses. You can't tell me you don't remember the Green Tea Goddess Green Tea Tickle?

(Singing—sort of:)

Green Tea Goddesses forever...

It's the Camp Teatotem way—

ANNE

Your cat.

MONICA

What?

ANNE

If I had Captain Snuffles as a hostage, I'd feel better.

MONICA

You want my cat?

(Beat.)

You can't take my cat.

ANNE

Not take. Just take for a little while. Until I'm sure.

MONICA

Of what?

ANNE

That these four hours aren't going to blow up in my face.

MONICA

I'm not giving you Captain Snuffles.

ANNE

Then stay up.

MONICA

I can't. Even if I wanted to, he's at my house.

ANNE

(Pointing at the box:)

Actually...

MONICA

You psycho! You kidnapped—

ANNE

He chases after Eddie.

MONICA

Oh yeah—he chases after your little brother for two miles right into a box in your room.

ANNE

It helps when Eddie rubs tuna fish all over his body and stands outside your window.

MONICA

(Getting up:)

I'm coming, Captain Snuffles...

Anne blocks her way.

ANNE

You don't look so tired now.

MONICA

Give me my cat.

ANNE

Give me a secret first.

MONICA

You're not being a good goddess.

(Beat.)

I'm not in love with Ryan. I don't even like him that much. I like Jerome, and since they're always standing next to each other, it looks like I'm in love with Ryan. Now give me my—

ANNE

I still have nightmares about that clown.

MONICA

What?

ANNE

The clown.

MONICA

(Beat.)

The one holding the cotton candy?

ANNE

He won't stop chasing me.

MONICA

But that's—

ANNE

Don't laugh at me. I should've never told you I—

MONICA

Did you know Captain Snuffles was specially trained as a clown-fighting cat?

ANNE

(Beat.)

Really?

MONICA

No.

ANNE

Oh. You're making fun of—

MONICA

But I'm not so bad at clown fighting.

ANNE

(Beat.)

Yeah?

MONICA

Yeah.

(Beat.)

My turn for another secret?

(The lights dim on Anne and Monica.)